

Equivalence Partitioning

A design technique that divides inputs or conditions into classes expected to behave equivalently.

Idea

Instead of testing every value, group valid and invalid values expected to be handled the same way.

Example

For accepted age 18–65: classes can be <18, 18–65 and >65.

Benefit

Reduces combinations while keeping representative coverage.

Caution

Classes must reflect real rules; poor partitions can hide meaningful differences.

QA Tip: After defining partitions, combine them with boundary values for stronger coverage.